



# Player Report on I. Hughes

Season 2025/2026 Club Wellington Phoenix

Date of Report 20-07-2026 Position LCB / RCB Age 22 Foot Right Height 1.83m

## **Physique**

A well-built, physically dominant centre-back — wins the vast majority of his defensive and aerial contests, a genuine physical presence.

## **Pace**

Not a mobile ball-carrier, but positioned to defend rather than to progress play himself.

## **Work-Rate**

Extremely disciplined off the ball — rarely fouls, rarely caught out of position.

## **Attitude**

Among the most dominant defenders covered in this cycle in one-on-one and aerial contests — real physical control of his box.

## **Technical**

A capable, accurate passer who can progress the ball when needed, without being a specialist distributor.

## **Intelligence**

Reads danger well and times interventions cleanly rather than relying on recovery pace — an old-school stopper profile with modern passing competence, and even chips in with the odd goal from set-piece situations.

## **Comments**

The most dominant defensive profile of the centre-backs covered here — outstanding in duels and in the air, disciplined, and capable enough on the ball not to be a liability in possession. A genuinely strong defensive foundation.

## **Strengths**

- Elite duel and aerial win rate
- Very disciplined — low foul count
- Reliable passer when asked to progress the ball
- Occasional goal threat from set pieces

## **Weaknesses**

- Not a ball-carrier or progressive runner
- Offensive duel engagement is modest
- Needs to be paired with more mobile cover alongside him

**Overall rating: 7 / 10**

**Fit pro HK: 6.5 / 10**